

SME Dashboard — UX Improvement Reference Notes

Comparing: [SME-Dashboard-v13.html](#) → [SME-Dashboard-UX-Improved-v1.html](#)

Branch: [User-Friendly-Wiki-App](#)

Date: May 2026

Summary

The improved version adds ~1,058 lines and removes ~1,027 from the original — a near-complete visual and structural overhaul focused on making the tool accessible to non-technical USPS staff (SMEs who are not data-savvy).

Change List & Why It's More User-Friendly

#	Change	What Changed	Why It's More User-Friendly
1	Design System Tokens	Replaced all hardcoded hex colors with named CSS variables (--blue , --gray-500 , --shadow-md)	Ensures visual consistency across every component — colors never drift between sections, making the UI feel polished and trustworthy
2	Base Font Size: 13px → 15px	html, body { font-size: 13px } increased to 15px	13px is below the comfortable reading threshold for most adults, especially on high-DPI screens; 15px reduces eye strain when reading long field descriptions

3	WCAG-Compliant Warning Color	Warning yellow changed from #fdb913 (fails WCAG AA) to #b45309 (accessible amber)	Users with low vision or color perception differences can now read warning labels; required by federal accessibility law
4	Onboarding Banner (New)	Added a dismissible tip banner at the top of the page (role="note", aria-label="Tip for new users")	First-time users get immediate guidance without reading separate documentation; dismissible so it doesn't clutter the workspace for returning users
5	Progress Tracker Card (New)	Welcome page now shows assets reviewed, pending items, and a visual progress bar (role="progressbar")	SMEs reviewing many assets need a sense of where they are; a visible progress indicator reduces anxiety and drives task completion
6	Beginner Mode Toggle (New) ★	Prominent toggle hides .advanced-term, .col-advanced, .technical-hint elements when enabled	Core feature of the non-data-friendly brief — strips technical jargon (partition keys, schema lineage) for non-technical SMEs; power users can toggle it off

7	Acronym Tooltips <i>(New)</i>	<code>.acronym</code> class with <code>data-tooltip</code> reveals definitions on hover/focus	Dashboard acronyms (CDAO, MDM, ETL) previously required Googling; definitions now appear inline without leaving the page
8	Navigation Icons	Each nav tab now includes an SVG icon (Home, Search, Document) beside the label	Icons give a second recognition cue beyond text — helpful for skimmers and users in a second language; tabs are easier to find at a glance
9	Help Button Redesign	Changed from solid blue <code>#0066cc</code> to transparent ghost style matching the header	The solid blue button competed visually with primary navigation; the ghost style signals "support is available" without demanding attention

10	Step Badges: Text → Circle Icons	"STEP 1 / STEP 2 / STEP 3" text badges replaced with circular SVG icon badges	Text step labels are redundant alongside numbered headings; icon badges are more scannable and communicate the nature of each step at a glance
11	Call-to-Action Button (New)	Large "Start Exploring →" primary button added below the step cards	Without a CTA, users on the Welcome page have no clear next step; the button removes ambiguity and reduces drop-off for non-technical users
12	Status Filter Pills (New)	Filter status controls redesigned as pill buttons with colored dot indicators (green / amber / red)	Color-coded pills are more scannable than plain checkboxes; users instantly see active filters without reading every label
13	Color-Coded Status Badges (New)	Asset cards show .status-badge.full , .partial , .pending with dot indicators	Documentation health is visible at a glance without clicking into each asset — critical for SMEs triaging which assets need attention

14	Empty State Guidance <i>(New)</i>	When no asset is selected, a numbered step guide with a large icon appears instead of a blank pane	Blank empty states feel broken to non-technical users; the guided state acts as a micro-tutorial and teaches the correct workflow
15	Filter Sidebar Redesign	Added subtitle text, section dividers, and moved Beginner Mode toggle to the very top	Placing Beginner Mode first signals it's a global priority setting; the subtitle gives context so users know what the sidebar is for
16	Line Height & Text Width	line-height increased from 1.55 → 1.6; description text capped at max-width: 620px	Full-width text lines are harder to read; the column cap keeps content comfortable and the extra line height improves scannability
17	ARIA Labels & Semantic Roles	Added aria-label , aria-current="page" , role="region" , role="progressbar" , aria-hidden on decorative elements	Screen reader and keyboard users can now navigate the page structure; required for federal Section 508 compliance

18	Attribute Summary Banner <i>(New)</i>	Banner above the asset detail table shows Total / Documented / Missing counts with color-coded values	SMEs don't need to scroll 50+ rows to assess documentation health; the banner delivers the "so what" immediately
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Files Referenced

File	Description
SME-Dashboard-v13.html	Original version before UX improvements
SME-Dashboard-UX-Improved-v1.html	Improved version with all changes above
SME-Dashboard-feature:non-data-friendly-UI.html	Intermediate working version
SME_Dashboard_Documentation_v3.pdf	Supplementary documentation